

OGRE TRIBES



WE PRESENT THREE DISTINCT OGRE CULTURES: THE highland tribes, the frostbound clans, and the marsh kings.

Ogre Tribes is a monster supplement for 5e that presents ogres not as a single interchangeable brute, but as evolving societies shaped by terrain, temperament, and ambition. Instead of relying on one generic ogre stat block, this book provides three complete and escalating NPC ladders: a rugged highland culture that serves as the baseline, a relentless icebound people hardened by winter, and a territorial swamp lineage whose temperament borders on absurdity.

These are not new ancestries. They are not subraces. They are environmental outcomes.

The intent of this product is cultural escalation and regional identity. Each ladder begins with a child and rises through increasingly dominant roles, reflecting not only greater strength, but greater authority, influence, and awareness. Low-tier ogres are impulsive and volatile. High-tier ogres are calculating, territorial, and capable of organizing war.

Geography, borders, and political alignment are intentionally undefined. These ogres can represent isolated mountain raiders along trade routes, tundra warbands testing settlement lines, or marshbound tyrants controlling waterways and backcountry paths. They are not meant to replace traditional ogres—they expand them, giving structure and identity to creatures often treated as disposable muscle.

How brutal they are, how organized they become, and whether they are conquerors or merely territorial survivors is left entirely in the GM's hands.

HIGHLAND OGRES

“THROW ROCK FIRST. ASK AFTER.”

The highland ogres are the baseline expression of ogre culture: rocky camps, crude cave holds, shattered watchtowers, and narrow mountain passes claimed through force.

They are not refined. They are not subtle. They value strength, visible dominance, and immediate retaliation.

Young ogres learn early that hesitation invites challenge. Adults establish authority through volume and violence. Leaders rise by defeating rivals publicly and decisively. Strategy exists—but it is practical, blunt, and direct.

Highland ogres are designed for:

- Borderland raids
- Mountain pass ambushes
- Siege encounters against crude stone forts
- Territorial disputes between expanding kingdoms and entrenched tribes

They are not masterminds. Their power lies in physical supremacy and the ability to unite under the biggest and most capable among them.

When they march, it is loud and unmistakable.

ICE OGRES

“COLD TEACHES PATIENCE.”

Ice ogres are born into scarcity.

The tundra does not forgive weakness. Food is seasonal. Shelter is fragile. Exposure kills the careless. As a result, frostbound ogres are harder, quieter, and more deliberate than their highland cousins.

They move across frozen rivers and wind-scoured plains with confidence. They conserve strength. They strike when prey slows. Their leaders plan around seasons rather than impulse.

Ice ogres are designed for:

- Harsh survival campaigns
- Frozen frontier settlements
- Long-distance raiding warbands
- Environmental attrition encounters

Their escalation reflects endurance and calculated brutality. By the time an ice ogre becomes a king, it is no longer merely strong—it is relentless.

They do not rage against winter - they endure it.

SWAMP OGRES

“THIS HERE’S MINE. ALL OF IT. EVEN THE WET BITS.”

Swamp ogres represent a different answer to survival.

Where highland ogres dominate rock and frost ogres master cold, swamp ogres claim what others discard: bogs, mangroves, flooded ruins, and slow black rivers.

They are territorial, loud, and unapologetically proud of miserable real estate. Their huts lean. Their bridges sink. Their armor smells. But the swamp is theirs.

Unlike their cousins, swamp ogres lean into personality. They boast. They taunt. They overestimate themselves. They bicker loudly—until an outsider steps too far into the reeds. Then they close ranks with surprising discipline.

Swamp ogres are designed for:

- Ambush-heavy marsh encounters
- Territorial waterway conflicts
- Improvised fortifications in difficult terrain
- Darkly humorous but lethal wilderness scenarios

They may seem ridiculous—until they are not. The mud favors those who know where to stand.

OGRE LADDER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Ogre Child	0	Noncombatant youth raised in rocky camps and crude cave holds. Their injury often triggers violent retaliation from nearby adults.
Ogre Brute	1	Baseline tribal warrior who relies on overwhelming strength and intimidation. Quick to anger and quicker to swing.
Ogre Reaver	3	Hardened raider trusted to enforce the will of stronger ogres. More controlled than a brute, but still driven by pride and fury.
Ogre Warcaller	5	Battlefield leader who rallies nearby ogres with thunderous roars and crushing advances. Directs raids through presence rather than strategy.
Ogre Overlord	7	Dominant tribal ruler who controls territory through calculated brutality and hard-earned cunning. Commands through fear and visible strength.
Ogre High Warlord	9	Apex leader capable of uniting multiple tribes into a regional threat. Combines immense physical power with practical battlefield awareness.

ICE OGRE LADDER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Ice Ogre Whelp	0	Young tundra-born ogre hardened by bitter winds and snow. Survives by clinging close to stronger kin in frozen camps.
Ice Ogre Breaker	1	Heavy-handed warrior who smashes through shields and ice alike. Uses brute strength to scatter foes across frozen ground.
Ice Ogre Stalker	3	Relentless hunter who moves confidently across snow and ice. Slows prey with chilling strikes before closing for the kill.
Ice Ogre Tyrant	5	Commanding tundra brute who dominates frozen battlefields. Drives allies forward with cold fury and crushing force.
Ice Ogre Chieftain	7	Leader of frost-bound tribes who plans seasonal raids and controls territory across harsh landscapes. Hard to kill and harder to outlast.
Ice Ogre King	9	Legendary ruler of the frozen wastes who unites scattered clans under one banner. Embodies endurance, cold resolve, and overwhelming might.

SWAMP OGRE LADDER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Swamp Ogre Bogling	0	Mud-smeared swamp youth raised in reed huts and rotting timber camps. Curious, loud, and fiercely territorial despite small size.
Swamp Ogre Basher	1	Thick-skinned swamp warrior who fights with crude clubs and whatever debris the marsh provides. Quick-tempered and foul-mouthed.
Swamp Ogre Enforcer	3	Territorial hunter who drags enemies into sucking mire before delivering disciplined, punishing blows. Knows every inch of the marsh.
Swamp Ogre Gator-Breaker	5	Battle-proven swamp champion who wrestles beasts and rivals alike. Commands through volume, bravado, and undeniable strength.
Swamp Ogre Boss	7	Dominant ruler of a swamp hold who controls territory through bluster, intimidation, and sudden bursts of calculated violence.
Swamp Ogre King	9	Self-proclaimed monarch of the marshlands who unites swamp ogres under a crude but effective hierarchy. Equal parts cunning, prideful, and brutally powerful.

OGRE REAVER

Large giant, chaotic evil

Armor Class 15 (reinforced hide and iron plates)

Hit Points 102 (12d10 + 36)

Speed 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
21 (+5)	9 (-1)	17 (+3)	8 (-1)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws Con +5, Wis +2

Skills Athletics +7, Perception +2

Senses passive Perception 12

Languages Giant

Challenge 3 (700 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Focused Assault. The reaver has advantage on melee attack rolls against creatures that are below half their hit points.

Pass Crasher. When the reaver moves at least 20 feet straight toward a creature and hits it with a melee attack on the same turn, the target must succeed on a DC 15 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone.

ACTIONS:

Multiattack. The reaver makes two greataxe attacks.

Greataxe. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 16 (2d10 + 5) slashing damage.

Hurl Boulder. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, range 30/120 ft., one target. *Hit:* 15 (2d8 + 5) bludgeoning damage.

- Targets injured or isolated creatures first.
- Uses downhill charges and terrain to knock enemies prone.
- Retreats only if clearly outmatched; otherwise presses advantage.



ICE OGRE CHIEFTAIN

Large giant, chaotic evil

Armor Class 17 (heavy frost-bound armor)

Hit Points 205 (19d10 + 95)

Speed 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
23 (+6)	10 (+0)	20 (+5)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)

Damage Resistances cold

Saving Throws Str +9, Con +8, Wis +5

Skills Athletics +9, Survival +5, Perception +5

Senses passive Perception 15

Languages Giant

Challenge 7 (2,900 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +3

Cold Command. Allied ice ogres within 30 feet have advantage on saving throws against being frightened.

Glacial Endurance. Once per turn, when the chieftain takes damage, it can reduce that damage by 8 (2d8).

Relentless Pursuit. The chieftain has advantage on opportunity attacks.

ACTIONS:

Multiattack. The chieftain makes three frostaxe attacks.

Frostaxe. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +10 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 19 (2d10 + 6) slashing damage plus 7 (2d6) cold damage.

Frozen Boulder. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +10 to hit, range 50/150 ft., one target. *Hit:* 18 (3d6 + 6) bludgeoning damage.

- Plans raids seasonally—winter offensives are most aggressive.
- Focuses on isolating targets in snow or difficult terrain.
- Hard to rout; morale rarely breaks.



SWAMP OGRES

SWAMP OGRE BOGLING

Large giant, chaotic neutral

Armor Class 9

Hit Points 18 (4d10 – 4)

Speed 30 ft., swim 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	9 (–1)	12 (+1)	4 (–3)	9 (–1)	8 (–1)

Senses passive Perception 9

Languages Giant

Challenge 0 (10 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Mire Native. The bogling ignores difficult terrain caused by mud or shallow water.

Loud Mouth. When the bogling takes damage, creatures within 10 feet have disadvantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks until the end of their next turn.

ACTIONS

Mud-Smeared Club. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) bludgeoning damage.

- Loud and territorial; alerts entire settlement if threatened.
- Comfortable in knee-deep water or unstable footing.
- Often underestimated until adults arrive.



COMPATIBLE CONTENT

Ogres found in the wild [Wilderness Encounter Maps](#).

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